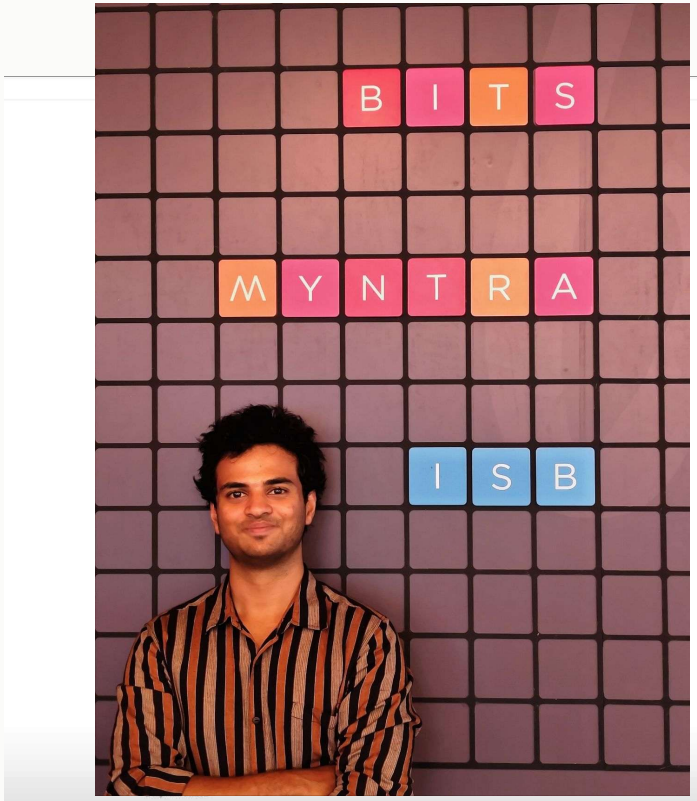
PM Placement Session

Aditya Raj Agarwal
27/08/2026

About Myself

- PM, Arcesium – Hedge Funds & B2B SaaS
- B.E. (Hons) Computer Science, BITS Pilani ‘19
- Front end software engineer – 4 years
  - Samsung Lockscreen App – 1.5 years
  - Myntra Mobile App – 2.5 years
- Pro Bono – Air Pollution Action Group
- A few case comps
- Life at ISB – VP, Quiz Club | Standup, Fashion Show, Podcast, Theatre, Running, Coffee, International Exchange (RSM)
- *PPTs gotilla*



What will we cover?

- Timeline for Prep
- Resume Making
- Company Selection Process
- Product Case Submission
- Interviews
- Case Study Example
- Placement Process Experience

What will we not cover?

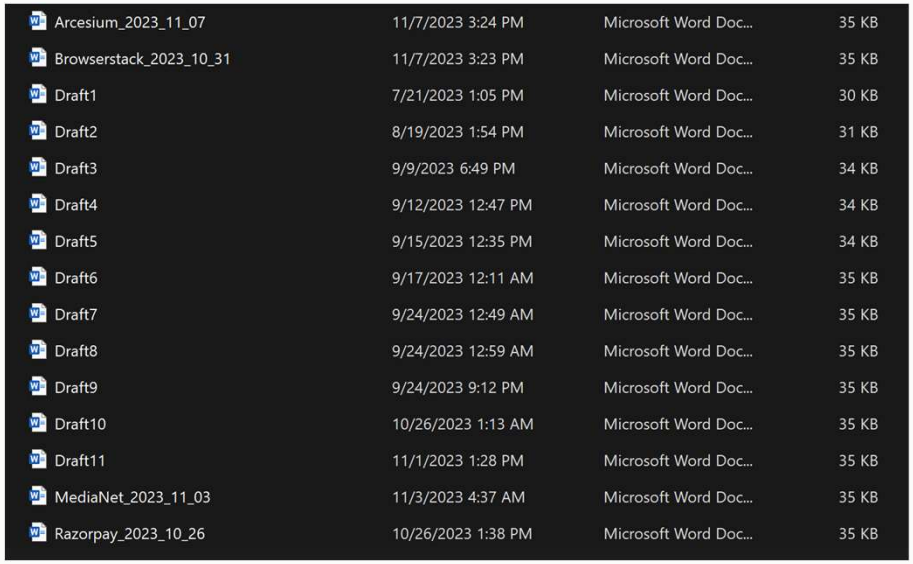
- How to decide if Product Management is the right choice for you?
- Can you prepare for Product Management and Consulting?
- What should be the backup?

Timeline | Resume | Company Selection | Case Submission | Interviews

- Basics and Frameworks Self Understanding – Aug/Sep
- Group Formation – Aug/Sep
- Resume – 17th September
- Case Comps – Jun-Sep
- Mock Interviews – Sep-Nov
- Shortlists – Oct-Nov
- Case Studies – November
- Final Interviews – Nov end and Dec Start

Questions

- Sections
  - ISB
  - Undergrad
  - Work Experience
  - Extra Curriculars



Arcesium_2023_11_07	11/7/2023 3:24 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Browserstack_2023_10_31	11/7/2023 3:23 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Draft1	7/21/2023 1:05 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	30 KB
Draft2	8/19/2023 1:54 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	31 KB
Draft3	9/9/2023 6:49 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	34 KB
Draft4	9/12/2023 12:47 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	34 KB
Draft5	9/15/2023 12:35 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	34 KB
Draft6	9/17/2023 12:11 AM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Draft7	9/24/2023 12:49 AM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Draft8	9/24/2023 12:59 AM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Draft9	9/24/2023 9:12 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Draft10	10/26/2023 1:13 AM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Draft11	11/1/2023 1:28 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
MediaNet_2023_11_03	11/3/2023 4:37 AM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB
Razorpay_2023_10_26	10/26/2023 1:38 PM	Microsoft Word Doc...	35 KB

- ISB
  - 3-5 lines
  - Projects – self / ELP / pro bono
  - Case Competitions
  - POR

- Undergrad
  - 2-3 lines
  - Relevant Internships
  - Relevant PORs

- Extra curriculars
  - Dependant on space (max 4 lines)
  - Purely talking point
  - Show impact if possible

Work Experience

- Sanity
  - The reader is not going to spend more than 5 minutes
  - For each point ask yourself the question – **“So What?”**
  - Know that the person reading your resume has **no background information**
  - RAC/STAR does not matter as much as **readability and consistency** does
    - What did you do, why, how, and did it work
  - **Boldface** is a valuable asset
  - Blue/Grey does not matter – **legibility matters**
  - **Know the “why”** behind each and every point – why the feature and why the metric
  - The absolute numbers do not matter as much as the knowledge of **how are they calculated**
  - **Know the main metric** you and your team were working to solve – helps in the flow of the points

Work Experience

- Actionables
  - **KMP is your friend**
  - Keep a **master sheet** of all the points for your work
  - Keep **multiple versions** of your resume depending on the company
  - Order the points (and use multiple lines) according to **what you want to be talked about**
  - **Resume reviews**
    - Rely on your placement prep group
    - Message a lot of alums – but be vary of which stage you want to do that
    - Do not take anyone's word as gospel
    - When opinions become contradictory – your work is done

Questions

Counters

- Application Counters
- Shortlist Counters
- Interview Counters
- Application counters < Shortlist counters < Interview counters

Tips

- PM shortlists come VERY late – Application Counters might be blocked
- If confident, avoid companies that have long due dates on shortlists
- Keep a couple of counters free if you can for surprise listings / safe companies, e.g., Navi
- Keep a safe company
- Companies do care about the relevancy of the background

Questions

- More than half the companies will have a case
- Very few companies will have aptitude test
- Multiple Cases in a single day – Prioritize and take help
- Anything from a 2 pager to 10 pager to Prototypes
- Keep the guidelines clear – be in contact with the CBD
- In case of doubt – do more rather than less
- Keep templates ready
- Practice Case studies – Past year studies amongst your placement group

Scroll down for example

Questions

Type of Questions

- Product Design
- Root Cause Analysis (RCA)
- Product Improvement
- Favourite Product
- Guesstimate
- Go-to-Market
- Product Strategy
- Technical
- Metrics
- Behavioural, WorkEx

Tips for preparing

- Prep groups – Try to keep at least one core group
- Practice with everyone – your peers are more than your competitors
- Mock Interviews – peers and alums
- Building product sense – discussions on groups and in classes (Teardowns)
- Have interview prep with a clock – usual question length should be 20-40 minutes
- Record yourself for interviews
- Keep scripts ready – favourite product, user persona, RCA
- Keep Framework Sheets for quick reference while preparing
- Understand basics (and limitations) of tech

Resources

- BTC Handbook for past questions
- YouTube pages for sample interviews – Exponent Free Videos, PM Exercises
- Use your own experiences for framing questions for peers

Questions

General Gyaan

- There will be bad days – Burnout is real; pace yourself
- Everyone operates differently – do not be intimidated
- Shortlist season will be filled with heartbreaks – you are not alone
- You will learn how much you can push yourself in these months
- You will learn how to ask for help
- This degree is more than just the first job that you get here

How to use KMP

Step 1



Step 2



Step 3

